Once again I brought tokens of appreciation for all of them and we took a group photograph to mark the occasion. I will always remember the way they treated me.

It was during my early-morning training sessions at the Wankhede that I met up with the MCA officials and told them about the ramp I required for my mother. I did not want to leave a single thing to chance and also checked out the box allocated to my family. In fact, it was when I was doing the initial recce that I realized that my mother would find it difficult. She is not in the best of health and it would have been difficult getting her up to the box from the car. That's when we decided that she should sit in the president's box instead and for safety I had also booked a room for her at the Garware Pavilion in case she felt tired and wanted to rest.

Having checked the route the wheelchair would have to take from the car to the ramp and finally to the president's box, and being fully convinced that it could all be done, I went ahead with the plan of formally inviting her. Being able to do this thing for my mother made the retirement Test match all the more special.

The last Ranji match

When I first met my team-mates from the Mumbai Ranji Trophy team after the announcement, a lot of them came up and asked me why I had decided to retire when I could have carried on for a while. It was an encouraging reaction and it felt good to see the faith they continued to have in me.

The last Ranji Trophy game I played for Mumbai was in Lahli against Haryana, which is a state just north of Delhi, and it turned out to be quite an experience. Before travelling to Lahli, I spoke with Anirudh Chaudhry, who was our manager in England in 2011, and his father Ranbir Singh Mahendra, who was our manager in Australia in 1991–92, at the Haryana Cricket Association. Anirudh had made special arrangements to put some of us up in the Chief Minister's guest house, which he said was a very relaxing place to stay. He had also arranged for extra security in order to make us feel comfortable.

We flew to Delhi on our way to Lahli and when we landed we were told by Anirudh that we should have lunch at the ITC Maurya hotel while he made the final arrangements. There was a pleasant surprise